



Civic.Social

Open infrastructure for civic life.

Shared, federated infrastructure for democratic participation.

THE PROBLEM

Our civic life is fragmented.

Hundreds of civic tools and pro-democracy efforts work to strengthen democracy — but without shared infrastructure they stay fragmented, hard to discover and hard to coordinate.

The problem isn't a lack of civic will — it's a lack of connection.

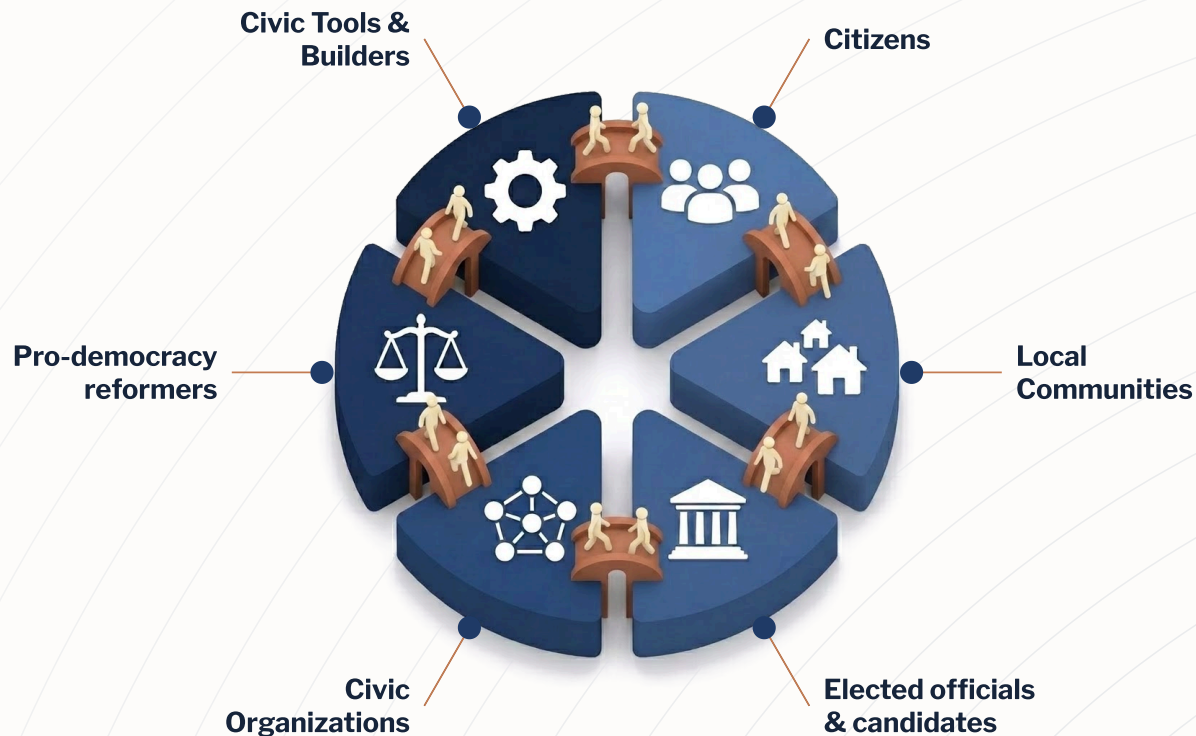


THE MISSING LAYER

What's needed isn't another tool. It's **shared infrastructure**.

Shared infrastructure that lets diverse civic efforts connect and interoperate while staying fully autonomous — not a centralized platform.

Roads, not cars. Civic.Social is the road; the civic apps people use are the cars that run on it.



THE COST OF STAYING FRAGMENTED

A movement too diffuse to drive systemic change.



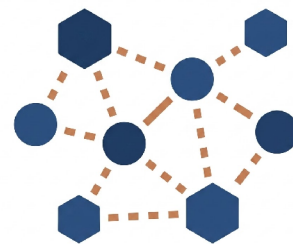
Citizen Cynicism

Engagement feels ineffective and participation remains episodic because user experiences are disjointed.



Wasted Resources

Organizations duplicate foundational infrastructure instead of advancing their missions.



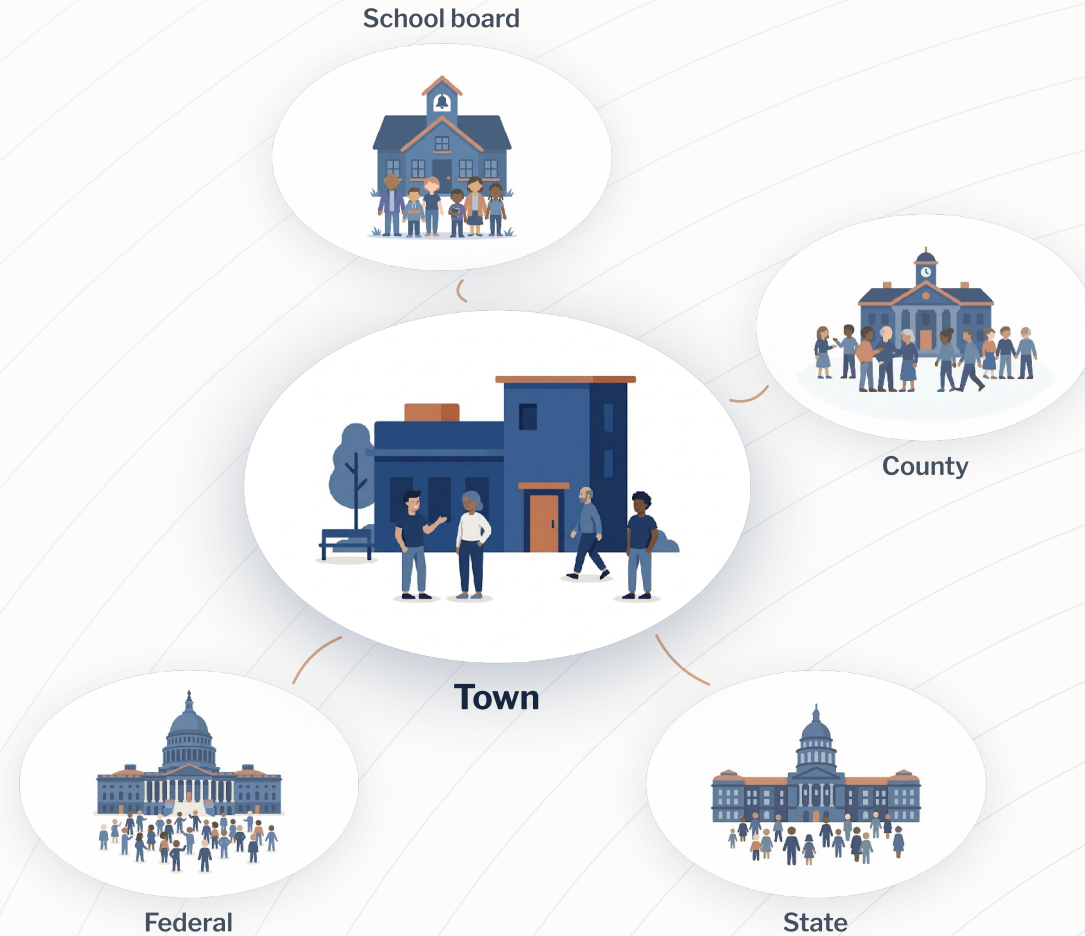
No Network Effects

Participation doesn't compound across time, place, or issue areas.

WHAT WE'RE BUILDING

Civic Hubs — civic spaces for communities.

- ◆ Organized around real communities and jurisdictions — **school board, town, county, state** — or communities of interest (e.g. **policy communities**).
- ◆ Where a town or county runs its **votes, budgeting, and deliberation** — and any other civic process it needs.
- ◆ Locally governed and **open-source** — each hub owns, moderates, and runs itself; **federation** keeps every hub interoperable.

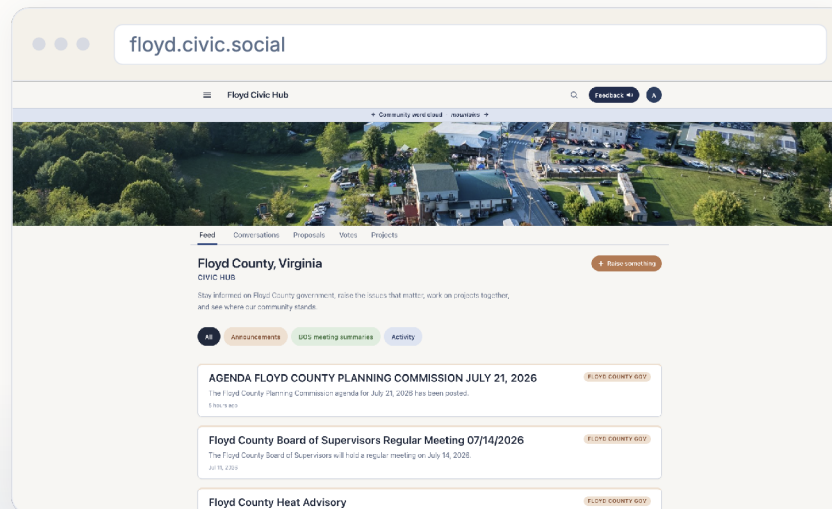


CIVIC HUB · LIVE PILOT

It's real — the Floyd County pilot.

Our flagship Civic Hub — built, and rolling out to my home county, Floyd County, Virginia.

- ◆ **County government in one place** — agendas, Board of Supervisors summaries, announcements, and advisories, aggregated automatically.
- ◆ **Participation built in** — Conversations, Proposals, Votes, and Projects; anyone can “Raise something.”
- ◆ **Running on the open Civic.Social specs** — so what works in Floyd works in any community.



● Live now · community rollout underway

Modular civic processes — plug into any space.

The things people actually do — voting, budgeting, deliberation. Built once and installed into whatever space needs them.

The same process runs in any space.

Civic Hub

Representative Space

Citizen Dashboard

Any website — embedded

+ future spaces

Build a process once, run it in any space — or embed it in any website. Process providers reach the whole ecosystem, not just one app.

An open process library

Developers build new civic processes against open specs and publish them to a shared library — any space can install them.



THE CORE IDEA

Built to fit, not to compromise.

Today a community faces a bad choice: adopt a rigid platform and compromise on fit, or commission bespoke software that's costly, unmaintained, and disconnected. The **Civic Space** is a **flexible container, not a fixed product** — and civic processes are **plugins**. Every community composes exactly what it needs.



The group primitive conforms to the community — **not the other way around.**

A hub is just one kind of Space.



COMMUNITY-SCOPED

Civic Hubs

For towns, counties, and school boards or any other jurisdiction — and for any community of interest.



PUBLIC OFFICE-SCOPED

Representative Spaces

For elected officials, candidates, and public institutions to interact with and be accountable to their constituents.



INDIVIDUAL-SCOPED

Citizen Dashboard

One access point to the whole Civic.Social ecosystem — find relevant civic information and aggregate updates from across every space.

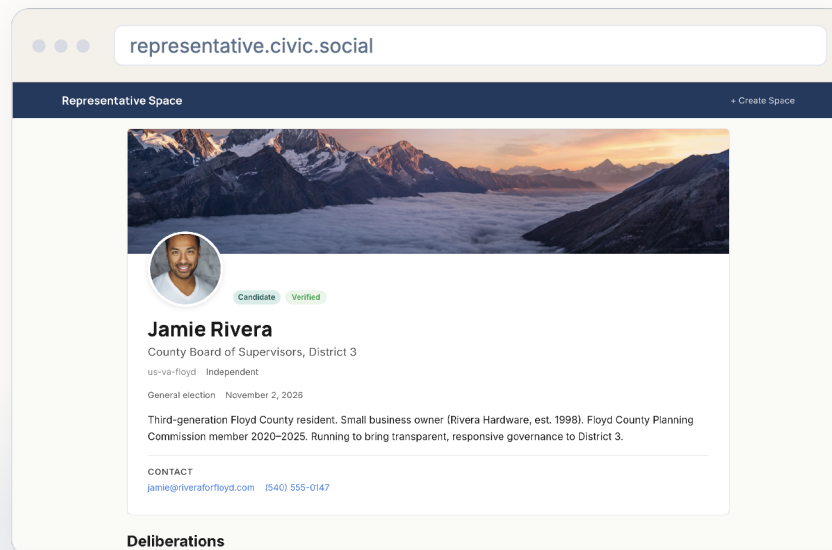


Your space
here

Three scopes — community, individual, and public office — with the same open interoperability specifications underneath. Anyone can build new spaces.

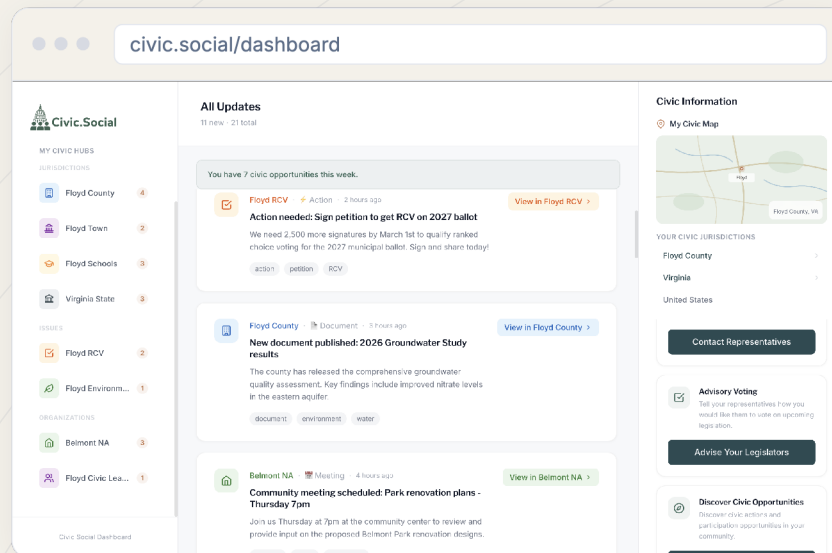
Representative Spaces — accountability and responsiveness for officials.

- ◆ A neutral, persistent, public-purpose surface for officials and candidates — **not a campaign site, not a social feed.**
- ◆ A place for **structured, substantive dialogue** with constituents — deliberation that finds common ground and demonstrates **verifiable responsiveness.**
- ◆ Officials share their positions and display **third-party badges and endorsements** — shown only by **mutual consent.**
- ◆ **Accountability by design:** the public record beside them — voting record, funding sources, delivered civic outcomes, response history — is **not theirs to edit.**



The Citizen Dashboard — your civic life in one place.

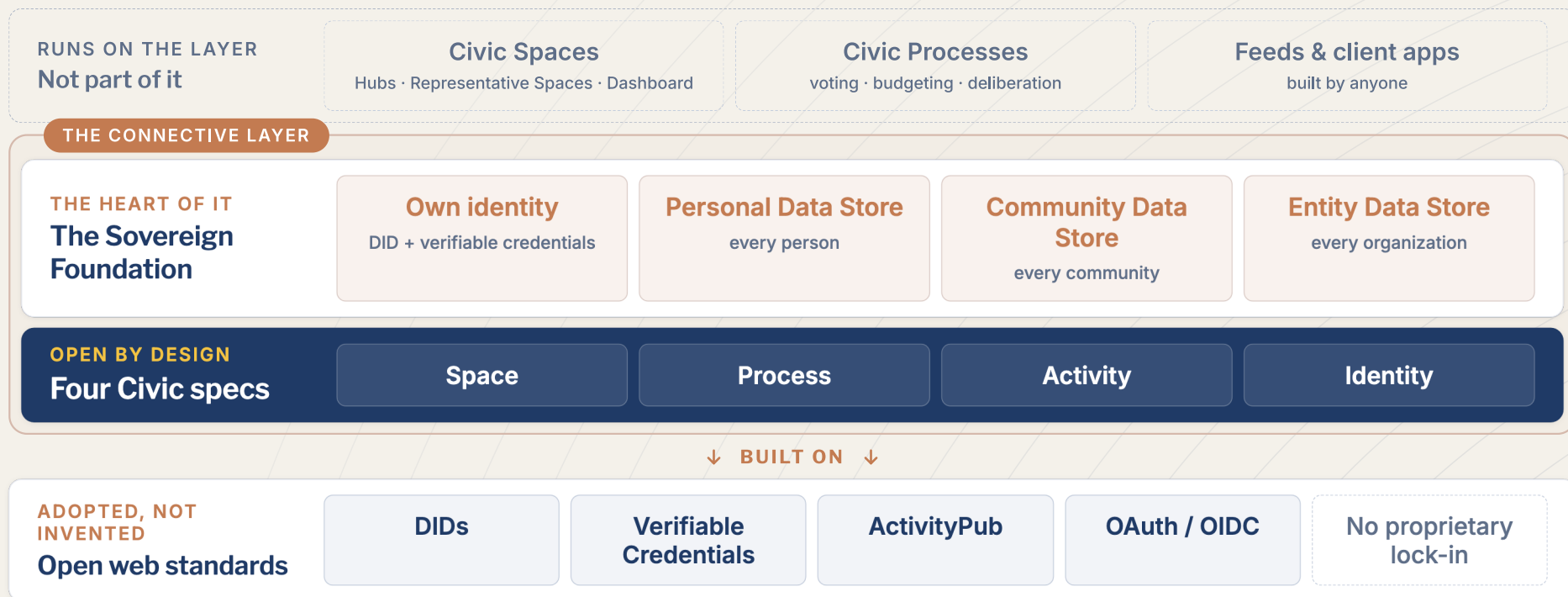
- ◆ The individual's "ecosystem browser" — follow the hubs, spaces, and issues you care about, with updates from **across every civic space** aggregated into a single feed.
- ◆ Pulls in the civic information that's relevant to you — **representatives, upcoming elections, and sample ballots** — with tools to act: **contact your representatives, weigh in on advisory votes.**
- ◆ The result: **one interface for civic life**, owned by the citizen.



HOW IT STAYS OPEN

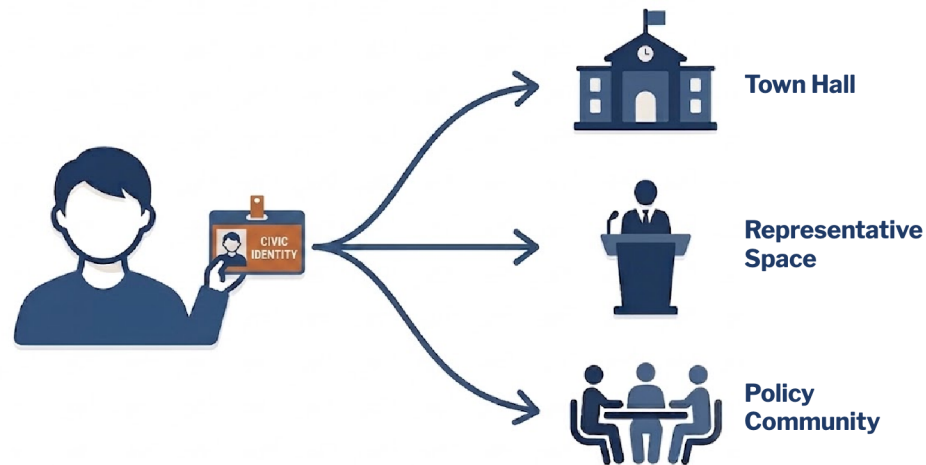
The connective layer.

The connective layer is **shared identity, portable data, and open specs** — not the apps. The voting, budgeting, and deliberation tools run on top of it.



One identity you own and carry everywhere.

- ◆ A **privacy-preserving identity** giving citizens streamlined access across every space and tool.
- ◆ Built on open W3C standards — **Decentralized Identifiers (DIDs)** and **Verifiable Credentials (VCs)**.
- ◆ Single sign-on without Big Tech or walled gardens — **the citizen owns it**, along with their social graph and preferences.

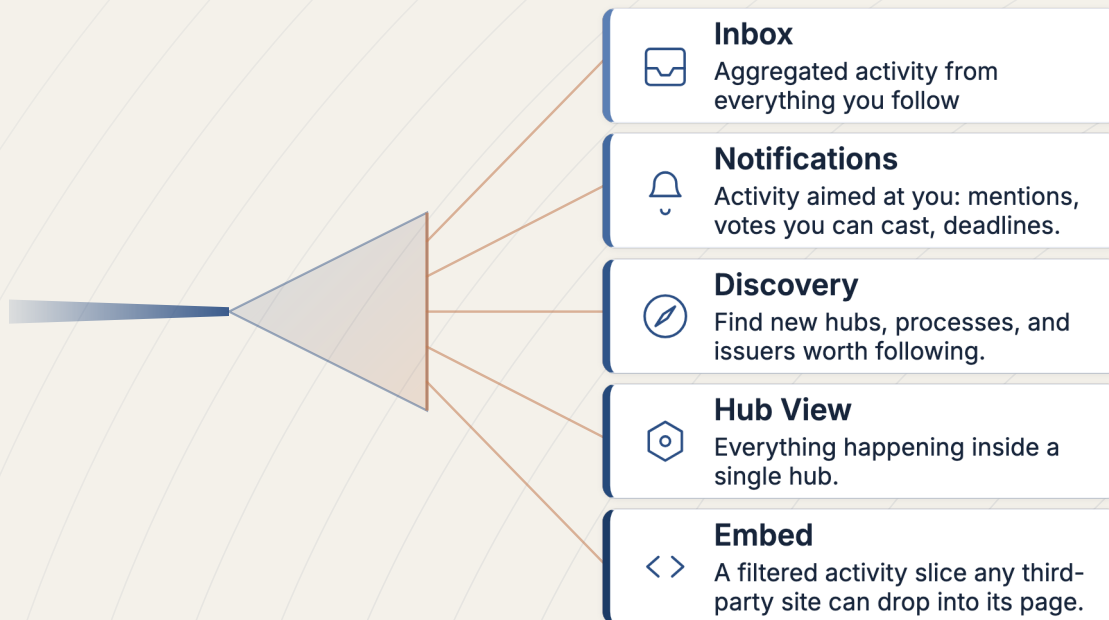


One shared stream that connects everything.

Every civic action — a vote, a proposal, a deliberation, a response — becomes a standardized **Civic Activity**: one stream, refracted into whatever view the moment calls for.

Civic Activity

one shared stream,
different lenses



THE CONNECTIVE LAYER · THE PAYOFF

No lock-in, by design.

PORTABLE

Identity

Your DID + credentials travel with you.

PORTABLE

Data

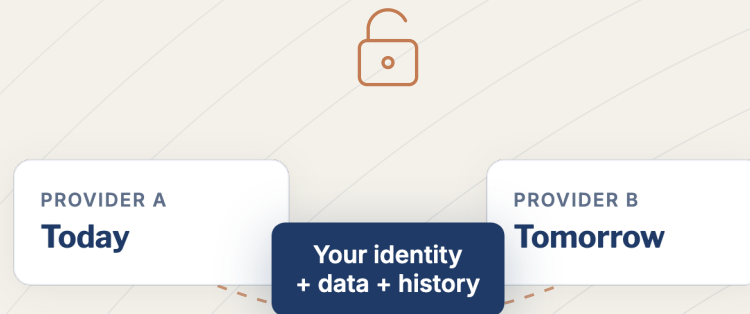
Personal, community, and entity data stores you can take anywhere.

MODULAR

Processes

The same process plugs into any space.

Portability means your identity and data — for individuals, communities, and organizations — are never trapped; switch providers and keep your history and relationships. Processes are modular: you choose your provider when you install one, not mid-run.



THE MODEL

The best of both worlds.

Nonprofit governance + the free market.

NONPROFIT STEWARD

Open standards

- ◆ Trust, neutrality — no capture
- ◆ Open to all, owned by no one
- ◆ Stewarded for the public interest
- ◆ Keeps the ecosystem interoperable & coherent



ONE
MODEL

OPEN MARKETPLACE

Many providers & services

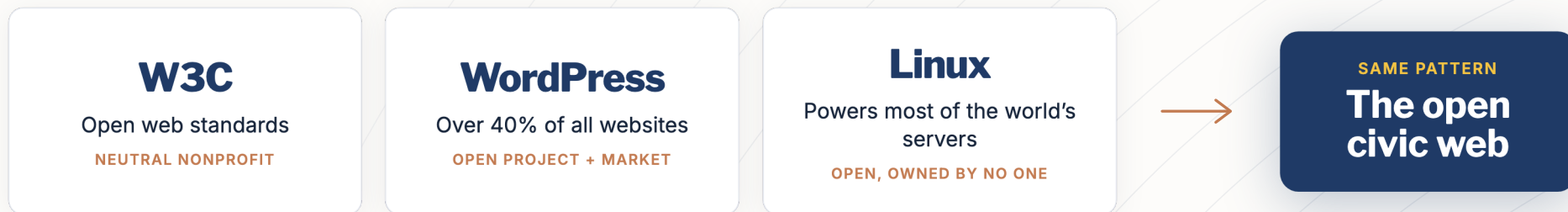
- ◆ Independent tools & services
- ◆ Permissionless innovation — anyone can build, no gatekeepers
- ◆ Thousands of builders, not one roadmap — the ecosystem grows faster and more capable
- ◆ Compete on quality, not lock-in

Openness is why the web outgrew every walled garden — an open civic ecosystem will outpace any single platform.

THE MODEL

This model already built the web.

A neutral nonprofit stewards the open standards; a vast competitive economy flourishes on top. No one owns the web.



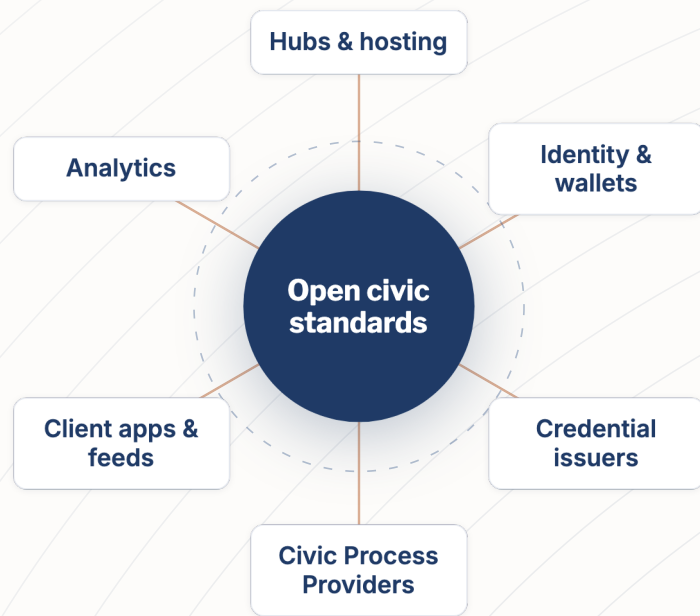
We bring the same proven institution to the civic web.

THE MODEL

An open marketplace of civic services.

Open standards mean any organization can build — and competition happens on quality, not lock-in.

Real opportunities for providers — and network effects no single company can monopolize.



THE BIGGER PICTURE

One model, many verticals.

Civic.Social is the first vertical of **Mosaic** — a neutral nonprofit stewarding open standards for public-interest digital infrastructure. A new institution for the web, in the tradition of W3C, WordPress, and Linux: open to all, owned by no one.

We're focused on Civic.Social for the next 2–3 years — proving the model where it's needed most.



Independent Media & Local Journalism

Communities & Clubs — mutual aid, interest groups

WHERE WE START

Civic.Social

Creators — video, audio, podcasting

Friends & Family — personal networks

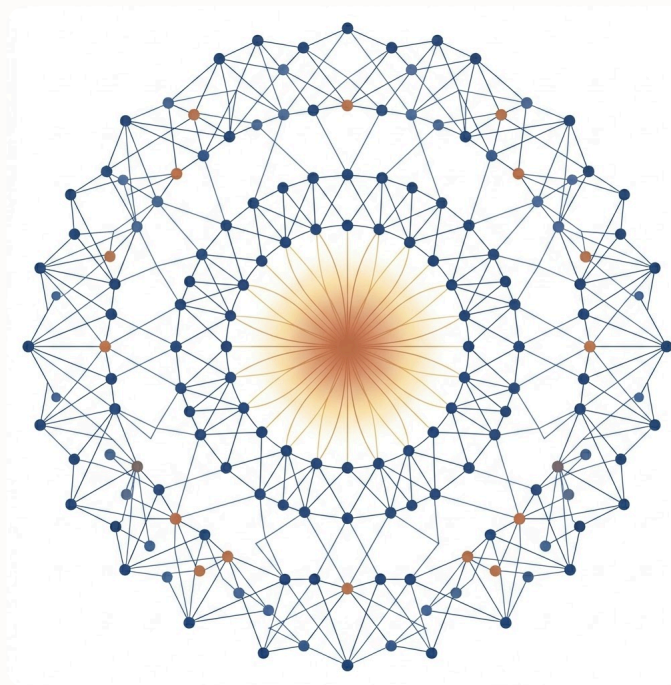
THE COMPOUNDING EFFECT

The power of a networked democracy.

Decentralized by design, integrated by choice
— every tool, hub, and space keeps full independence. What integration compounds:

- ◆ **Compounded participation**
Engagement carries forward across platforms and jurisdictions.
- ◆ **Visible collective momentum**
Isolated efforts appear as one unified civic movement.
- ◆ **Cross-jurisdiction learning**
Policies and processes spread and adapt rapidly.
- ◆ **Legible public will**
Aggregated participation becomes a structured, verifiable civic signal.
- ◆ **Collective leverage**
Integrated civic energy becomes a coordinated political force.

A small engaged fraction + meaningful integration = systemic change.



Network effects are greater than the sum of the parts.

THE ECOSYSTEM, CONCRETELY

How organizations plug in.

Illustrative examples — not partnerships or endorsements.

Civic hub networks & bridging orgs

Run their local civic hubs on shared open infrastructure — many hubs, one network.

Better Together America

Braver Angels

Reform & advocacy organizations

Convene participation and run regional or chapter hubs.

RepresentUs

Open Primaries

Civic process providers (plugins)

Offer their tool as a plugin any civic space can install.

Polis

Decidim

Civic IQ

advisory voting

contact-your-rep

Credential & badge issuers

Issue verifiable civic badges and pledges.

Team Democracy

Reboot America

American Promise

RepresentUs (Anti-Corruption Act)

Independent-politics & candidate communities

Run Representative Spaces and community hubs.

Forward Party

Brand New Congress

United Independents

Research & analytics

Measure participation and hub impact across the ecosystem.

e.g., helping a network like Better Together America see its impact

Why this matters for partners.



FOR CIVIC ORGANIZATIONS

Run your programs, not a platform.

Host your votes, deliberations, and campaigns on shared infrastructure you don't have to build — reaching citizens already in the ecosystem, on your own terms.



FOR PROCESS PROVIDERS

Build once, reach everywhere.

One integration with the open standard puts your tool in front of every hub, space, and community — no per-platform builds.



FOR COMMUNITIES

Connection without consolidation.

Run your own civic space, governed locally — connected to every other civic space, owned by no platform.



FOR THE MOVEMENT

Compounding momentum.

Scattered efforts become one legible, coordinated civic force that grows with every participant.

Rather than competing for fragmented attention, civic efforts reinforce one another.

STEWARDSHIP

Built in the open, owned by no one.

Civic.Social is the flagship initiative of the **Mosaic Foundation**, a nonprofit building open, interoperable public digital infrastructure. It's developed collaboratively — civic innovators, community builders, researchers, and mission-aligned organizations defining shared standards and governance together.

- **Already running** — Representative Space and Citizen Dashboard demos are live, and we're deploying a pilot Civic Hub with structured deliberation in a real community (Floyd County, VA).



Shared standards, shared governance —
defined together.

AN OPEN TABLE

Civic innovators

Community builders

Researchers

Mission-aligned organizations

Local communities

THE PILOT PROGRAM

Six modular pilots — each proves one layer.

Each pilot stands on its own and can run in parallel or in sequence. Together they compose the full ecosystem — and each is scoped to budget.



CIVIC SPACES

Civic Hubs

Community-run civic spaces, deployed with real communities; governance and processes tested live.



PROCESSES

Civic Process Plugins

A modular framework so one process runs in any space — or embedded on any website.



IDENTITY

Civic Identity

Portable, citizen-owned sign-on (DIDs) and verifiable credentials that work across the ecosystem.



ACTIVITY

Civic Activity Feed & Discovery

An “inbox for civic life” — surfacing ecosystem-wide activity through lenses you can filter by.



INTERFACE

Citizen Dashboard

One unified civic view for the individual, across hubs, spaces, and issues.



RECOGNITION

Civic Credentialing

Verifiable civic badges and public profiles that make recognition visible.

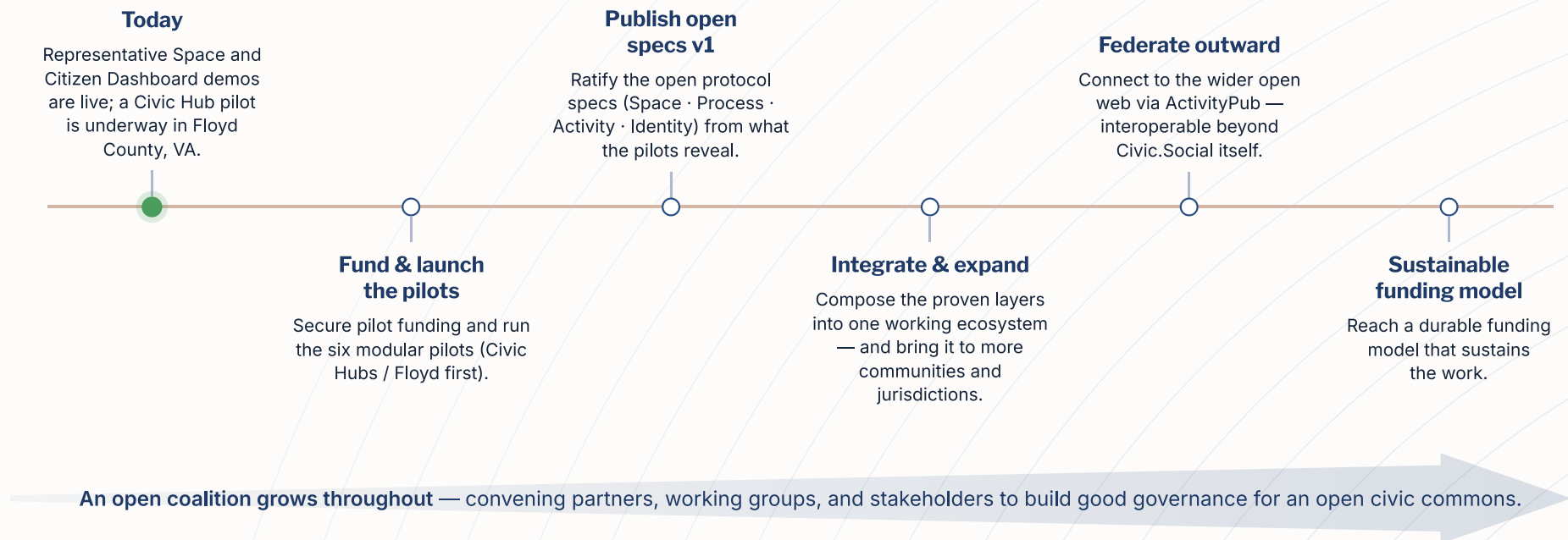
Flexible by design — run in parallel or in sequence. Suggested starting point: **Civic Hubs (Floyd County)**, the execution node everything else plugs into.

SCOPED TO BUDGET

Spec & prototype → Reference deployment → Live community pilot

WHERE WE ARE, WHERE WE'RE HEADED

The road ahead.



GET INVOLVED

Build Civic.Social with us.

Open infrastructure for 21st-century civic participation.

Join the coalition

Add your name to the open coalition; help shape the standards as working groups convene.

Partner on a pilot

Run a pilot in your community, or partner on one — we'll write you into the proposal.

Fund civic infrastructure

Back the pilots and the open infrastructure for 21st-century democracy.

Help build the founding team

Connecting with the right people ahead of funding — reach out, or refer someone great.

Closing the gap between public will and public policy.

Adam Lake, Founding Steward · adam@civic.social · www.civic.social

A Mosaic Foundation initiative